MEBENDAZOLE

Chewable

Avoid in 1st trimester

CHEMICAL NAME Methyl N-(6-benzoyl-1H-benzimidazol-2-yl)carbamate
CLASS Benzimidazole anthelmintic
TRADE NAMES Vermox · Ovex · Emverm · Antiox

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Threadworm (enterobiasis).
- Roundworm, whipworm, hookworm (single or mixed infections).
- Mass deworming of children.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO**; tablets may be chewed, swallowed or crushed; with or without food.
- Suspension for young children.

DOSAGES

- **Threadworm (adult & child >2 yr):** 100 mg single dose; repeat after 2 weeks.
- **Other worms:** 100 mg twice daily for 3 days, or 500 mg chewable tablet once (roundworm/whipworm, ≥1 yr).
- Children 6 months–2 yr: use only if benefit outweighs risk (per guideline).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- Very poorly absorbed (5–10%) → acts in gut lumen.
- Absorbed fraction metabolised in liver.
- Excreted mainly in faeces. **t½:** 3–6 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Binds parasite **β-tubulin** → blocks microtubule formation and glucose uptake → parasite immobilisation and death.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Abdominal pain, diarrhoea, flatulence.
- Nausea.
- Rash.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Neutropenia, hepatitis (high doses, long courses).
- Convulsions in infants (rare).
- SJS/TEN with metronidazole (reported).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- First trimester of pregnancy (relative).
- Children <6 months.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Metronidazole:** SJS/TEN reported; avoid combination.
- **Cimetidine:** ↑ levels.
- **Carbamazepine, phenytoin:** ↓ levels.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Treat all household members at the same time for threadworm.
- Schedule the repeat dose after 2 weeks.
- Teach hygiene measures.
- Check pregnancy status.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Wash hands and scrub nails before meals and after the toilet.
- Wash sheets, towels and nightwear on day 1.
- Take the second dose 2 weeks later.
- Morning shower helps remove eggs.

KEY POINTS

- Benzimidazole for threadworm and gut worms.
- Treat the whole family.
- 100 mg, repeat after 2 weeks for threadworm.
- Poorly absorbed — acts in the gut.

SOURCES CHECKED **[258]** Vermox 100 mg tablets (UK SmPC) **[259]** Vermox, oral (US label)
Full references p. 432–457